

Rakesh G Sekhar

Senior Backend Engineer | Cloud-Native Backend Systems | Java | Distributed Services
Bangalore, India | +91 7994398779 | iam.rakeshsekhar@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Engineer with 7+ years of experience building scalable backend services, microservice-based applications, and cloud-native systems using Java and Spring Boot. Experienced in designing high-performance APIs, improving production reliability, optimizing distributed workloads, and building observable backend systems. Strong background in Java, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, CI/CD, and backend performance engineering.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Python, Scala (working knowledge)

Backend & Distributed Systems: Spring Boot, Microservices, REST API Design, GraphQL (BFF), Event-Driven Systems (Kafka), Distributed Caching, Concurrency, System Design, High Availability

Data & Storage: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS (working knowledge), CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab CI), Cloud-Native Architecture

Observability & Testing: Prometheus, Grafana, AppDynamics, Load Testing, API Testing, Unit Testing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco Systems India Pvt. Ltd. — Software Engineer (Grade 6)

Bangalore, India | 2021 – Present

- Reduced end-to-end request latency by 96% by eliminating redundant serialization/deserialization in processing ~8K+ reports per request and introducing optimized in-memory HashMap lookups, significantly improving latency and memory utilization under scale.
 - Designed and implemented canary deployment traffic-shaping logic, enabling safer incremental rollouts and reducing deployment risks through controlled rollback mechanisms.
 - Led a Java Spring Framework upgrade across multiple critical backend services, resolving dependency conflicts and performance regressions while maintaining zero downtime in production.
 - Improved production observability by driving logging and telemetry enhancements across backend services, integrating Prometheus and Grafana to reduce incident detection and troubleshooting time.
 - Built high-volume load-testing tools in Java and Scala to simulate production traffic, identify bottlenecks, and improve service reliability under peak load.
 - Strengthened release reliability by integrating automated API validation and post-deployment testing into CI/CD pipelines, reducing production-critical failures by 95%.
 - Designed and shipped a high-impact Import/Export feature for Webex Analyzer, improving customer workflows and enabling efficient report portability.
 - Applied data structure and algorithmic optimizations to latency-critical request paths, improving time and space efficiency for high-throughput backend processing.
 - Collaborated across backend and platform teams to improve deployment reliability, observability, and production stability for customer-facing analytics services.
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IBS Software — Senior Software Engineer

Trivandrum, India | 2019 – 2021

- Re-architected legacy business modules including Cargo Booking and Flight Scheduling from a monolithic architecture to Spring Boot-based microservices, reducing code complexity by 40% and improving throughput by 35%.
- Owned the design and development of a Backend-for-Frontend (BFF) layer, defining API contracts and aggregating data efficiently for multiple frontend applications.
- Reduced Internal Server Errors by 90% through improved validation, defensive programming, and enhanced exception handling in critical booking services.
- Led the design and implementation of a Micro Frontend (MFE) architecture, enabling independent development and deployment of core business modules.
- Worked closely with product and engineering teams to modernize backend workflows and improve maintainability across customer-facing applications.

B Positive Institute for Skilling — Technical Trainer

2018 – 2019

- Designed and delivered advanced training programs in Java, Python, and Data Structures & Algorithms for students and faculty members.
- Developed structured curricula focused on problem-solving, algorithmic thinking, and core computer science fundamentals.

OPEN SOURCE & SIDE PROJECTS

Trip Pilot — Personal Travel Planning Platform

- Building a cloud-native travel planning platform using Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, and Flutter.
- Designing scalable backend APIs, containerized local development environments, and itinerary planning workflows.
- Focused on backend architecture, API reliability, and extensible microservice-ready design.

Time Formatter (npm)

- Designed and published a lightweight npm library for consistent, locale-aware time formatting.
- Focused on clean API design, semantic versioning, documentation, and backward compatibility.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science University of Kerala, Trivandrum | 2014